

PAPER

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2019

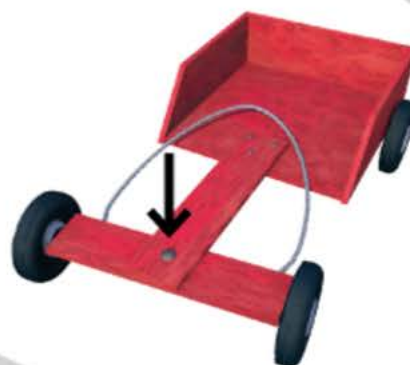
ENGLISH

Dear Diary

Thursday 22 June

I can hardly write about the dreadfulness of it all. You know the story so far, Diary: weeks spent planning my billycart, just a couple of days building it, and only a few hours last night painting it, ready for the big race. Yes, I realise that 'dreadfulness' is an unhappy sounding word, but it describes today's events perfectly.

At 9 am exactly we lined up at the starting point on George Street. Mrs Digby waved her chequered flag around as if her life depended on it, and we took off. Thirty-two homemade billycarts tore down the hill. I was in front. I was smug. Have you heard the expression 'Pride comes before a fall'? In my case it wasn't so much a fall, as a head-on collision with the hay bale barrier at the end of George Street.



I've drawn the racetrack on the map. See that sharp right-hand bend into Queen Street? I've circled it on the map. Well, Diary, I missed it completely. Sailed straight ahead into the hay bales, didn't I? And why, you ask, did I miss the turn? Well, for that explanation we need to return to the plans. It seems that I made an error with the steering mechanism: it didn't steer! In my effort to make sure that the cart held together, I had over-tightened the bolt holding the front axle (I've marked it with an arrow on the picture). I know what you're thinking, Diary. I agree that a test run would've indicated the problem, but I'd hardly had time to put the wheels on, let alone have a test run.

So, there I was. Me, the cart and the hay bales. I sat among the mess and watched 31 fully-functioning carts successfully turn the corner. Sally Harris, who is supposed to be my best friend, even had the nerve to wave and smile at me as she went past. Here's a new word for you, Diary, since you don't like 'dreadfulness': chagrin. It means disappointment or humiliation.

~Anna

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Anna wrote her diary in a way that suggested she was

- ☐ hiding her feelings.
- ☐ planning for the next race.
- ☐ sharing the day's events.
- ☐ defending her decisions.

'Mrs Digby waved her chequered flag around as if her life depended on it'

This description suggests that Mrs Digby waved her flag

- ☐ fearfully.
- ☐ carefully.
- ☐ suddenly.
- ☐ energetically.

The word 'smug' means that Anna

- ☐ was determined to do her best.
- ☐ felt cosy in her cart.
- ☐ felt confident that she would do well.
- ☐ was proud to be taking part in the race.

Anna missed the turn into Queen Street because

- ☐ the cart was travelling too fast.
- ☐ the right-hand bend was too sharp.
- ☐ there were hay bales in her way.
- ☐ there was a fault with her cart.

Anna drew the circle on the map to show

☐

where the race started.

☐

where the cart crashed.

☐

where George Street is.

☐

where the race finished.

Anna accepted that her accident could have been prevented by

☐

spending more time building the cart.

☐

trying out the cart before the race.

☐

tightening the bolts and screws before the race.

☐

becoming more familiar with the racetrack.

'Sally Harris, who is supposed to be my best friend, even had the nerve to wave and smile at me as she went past.'

This quotation tells readers that Anna thought Sally was

- ☐ being disloyal to her.
- ☐ cheating in the race.
- ☐ partly responsible for her accident.
- ☐ desperate to win the race.

Sugar

JB Smith is the host of *Amazing Animal Mornings*. Today he is interviewing the sugar glider, **Sugar**. This is the transcript of their interview.

JB: Good morning. Good morning! Er, is that ... *Petaurus breviceps*?

Sugar: You can just call me Sugar.

JB: Right, well thanks, Sugar, for agreeing to speak with me.

- 5 **Sugar:** No problem, although remember if I yawn, it's because I've been up all night. I usually spend my days asleep.

JB: Really? Shift work?

- 10 **Sugar:** Not exactly. I'm nocturnal. Actually all my family is.

JB: But how do you get around when it's so dark?

Sugar: Ha! Spoken like a true human.

- 15 It's not as dark as you think. There are the moon and the stars, don't forget. That's all I need. See how I've got such huge eyes for the size of my head?

JB: And quite protruding, if I may say so.

- 20 **Sugar:** Yes, well ... that combined with my very large pupils and my high number of rods, all mean I can collect every bit of light there is, so I can see in the dark.

JB: Sorry, did you say rods?

- 25 **Sugar:** Yes, they're special cells in the retina that are incredibly sensitive to any photons or light particles. You've got rods in your eyes too, but I've got many, many more.



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JB: Lucky you! Hmm, I hope you don't mind me saying, Sugar, that you've got rather large ears as well.

Sugar: Not at all! I'm proud of my ears. See how the lobes are very thin and
30 broad? That amplifies even the tiniest noise. And look at this—

JB: Wow! You can wiggle each ear separately! Do it again!

Sugar: No problem (*swivels ears*). Yes, I can swivel them around, so I can sense sounds in every direction. In fact, I think I can hear an insect right now ... somewhere over ... THERE!

35 (*Sugar stretches out her arms and legs and leaps into a glide.*)

JB: Right, well, I think I've lost connection there with Sugar. She's ... er ... having breakfast.

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'Good morning! Er, is that ... *Petaurus breviceps*?'
Which punctuation indicates that JB paused when asking this question?

☐

!

☐

...

☐

Capital P

☐

?

Sugar's eyes are described as 'protruding'.
If JB's eyes were also protruding, which picture would they look most like?

☐

☐

☐

☐


'Sorry, did you say rods?'

This question is used by JB to

- ☐ challenge Sugar's comment.
- ☐ check what Sugar said.
- ☐ comfort Sugar.
- ☐ confuse Sugar.

According to the text, what is the difference between a human eye and a sugar glider's eye?

- ☐ A human eye is more sensitive to light.
- ☐ A human eye has more cells in the retina.
- ☐ A sugar glider's eye has a larger number of rods.
- ☐ A sugar glider's eye has a smaller pupil.

Sugar was not offended by JB's comment about her ears.

Which quotation from the text most directly supports this statement?

- ☐ 'I hope you don't mind me saying' (line 27)
- ☐ 'I'm proud of my ears.' (line 29)
- ☐ 'See how the lobes are very thin and broad?' (lines 29-30)
- ☐ 'I can sense sounds in every direction' (lines 32-33)

'And look at this—' (line 30)

In this quotation, what is Sugar referring to?

- ☐ the shape of her ears
- ☐ the way her ears move
- ☐ the size of her ears
- ☐ the way her ears feel

'(Sugar stretches out her arms and legs and leaps into a glide.)'

This information is written in brackets because

- ☐ it is explaining the word 'THERE'.
- ☐ it is scientific detail.
- ☐ it is less important.
- ☐ it is describing an action.

This text could be described as

- ☐ entertaining and informative.
- ☐ informative and procedural.
- ☐ entertaining and persuasive.
- ☐ procedural and persuasive.

BUG buffet



Today's lunch will be fried grasshoppers, fresh fly larvae and spiced cockroaches, with honeyed locusts for dessert. It might sound disgusting, but it's a healthy meal.

You may not be ready to tuck into a big plate of crispy grasshoppers, but in many cultures eating insects is part of a normal diet—some insects are even a delicacy! People in Africa, Asia and Australia have eaten insects as part of their diet for thousands of years.

There are currently 1462 recorded species of edible insects, including ants, dragonflies, grasshoppers, termites and fly larvae. But why would anyone eat insects?

Insects are a good source of protein, and many contain minerals such as calcium, iron and zinc. Eating 100 grams of cooked caterpillar can provide more than your daily requirement of iron, copper, zinc and thiamin. Almost all insects have more iron than beef and fish, while dung beetles and termites have quite a high level of protein. Many insects are also lower in fat than beef, lamb, pork or chicken.

Nutritional values		
	Nutritional value per 100 grams	
	Protein (grams)	Iron (milligrams)
Dung beetle	17.2	7.7
Cricket	12.9	9.5
Grasshopper	14.3	3.0
Caterpillar	6.7	13.1
Termite	14.2	35.5
Weevil	6.7	13.1
Beef	27.4	3.5
Fish	28.5	1.0



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So what is the yummiest way to eat insects? Well, it depends on what you like. Insects can be fried, boiled, roasted, barbequed, stir-fried, ground up or freeze-dried. If you have a sweet tooth, you can get your insects in a lollipop. Many insects are eaten as larvae but ants, grasshoppers and crickets are almost always eaten as adults. Grasshoppers are the most widely eaten insect and can be eaten salted or ground up and baked into a cake.

'Yuck, I'd never eat bugs,' I hear you say. Well, you may not know it, but you will probably eat half a kilogram of bugs in your lifetime or maybe even more. Insect body parts contaminate many everyday foods found in your kitchen. Dried foods such as flour and oats often contain insect eggs and if left at room temperature for long enough, these eggs will eventually hatch into larvae. Even chocolate can contain insect body parts!

Before you go out and start collecting bugs for your own buffet, there are a few rules you should know. First, brightly coloured insects such as some caterpillars should be avoided as they are likely to be poisonous. Second, insects that contain poison, such as wasps, must be boiled so the stinger and poison don't make you sick. Third, any insects sprayed with garden poisons and insecticides should not be eaten.

Finally, don't forget: if you decide to tuck into some tasty fly larvae, make sure that you share them with your friends.

Text: "Bug buffet" text from 'Grossed out! Bug buffet' by Sarah Leonardi, The Helix www.csiro.au/doublehelix © CSIRO. Reproduced with permission. Images: see acknowledgements



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The writer describes some insects as a 'delicacy'.
This means that they are

- ☐ very fragile.
- ☐ difficult to cook.
- ☐ commonly eaten.
- ☐ especially prized.

'There are currently 1462 recorded species of edible insects, including ants, dragonflies, grasshoppers, termites and fly larvae.'
Which option suggests that more species will probably be added to that list?

- ☐ 'currently'
- ☐ '1462'
- ☐ 'edible'
- ☐ 'including'

What feature of the table best highlights the nutritional value of insects compared with beef and fish?

- ☐ the use of shading
- ☐ the list of different insects
- ☐ the even width of the columns
- ☐ the use of grams and milligrams

According to the table, which of the following statements is correct?

- ☐ Beef contains more protein than fish.
- ☐ Fish contains more iron than caterpillars.
- ☐ Caterpillars contain more iron than weevils.
- ☐ Dung beetles contain more protein than termites.

Why does the writer say that 'you will probably eat half a kilogram of bugs in your lifetime' (paragraph 6)?

- ☐ It is common for people to eat insects without knowing it.
- ☐ This is the quantity of insects that people require in their diet.
- ☐ Most people will eventually decide to try eating some insects.
- ☐ Being eaten by humans is part of the life cycle of some insects.

According to the text, which of the following statements about eating insects is correct?

- ☐ All insects can be eaten if they are properly prepared.
- ☐ The grasshopper is the most popular insect eaten.
- ☐ All flying insects are made safe by boiling them.
- ☐ Only adult insects are eaten by people.

The overall tone of the final sentence is

- ☐ humorous.
- ☐ sarcastic.
- ☐ demanding.
- ☐ enthusiastic.

Throughout the text, what does the writer assume about her readers?

- ☐ They would like to experiment with eating insects.
- ☐ They have probably tried eating insects in the past.
- ☐ They would naturally dislike the idea of eating insects.
- ☐ They are looking for new ways to prepare insects to eat.

My Grandad

Gramps arrived at the door, late one August night;
His hair all dishevelled, he looked quite a sight.
'Your granny and I've had a slight disagreement,
Could I stay for the night, just if it's convenient?'

5 This time it was a rosebush and pruning it bare,
Plus the dog and its habits led to despair.
It seems that Granny was really quite cross,
So Gramps retreated ... he knew who was boss.

I loved these times when Gramps came to stay,
10 He shared my room while he was 'away'.
I especially enjoyed the bedtime process
When Gramps underwent a meta-mor-phosis.

Off came his glasses, placed into their box
Next came the dentures and smelly grey socks.
15 His hairpiece came off and dear Gramps looked so old,
But how I loved these times and the stories he told.

These stays were short-lived because Granny would call
And say to my mother, 'It's nothing at all.
He makes it all up just so he can stay
20 A night with our grandson, young Thomas McClay.'

Shelley Wylie

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The poet uses the word 'meta-mor-phosis' to describe the change in Gramps's

- ☐ mood.
- ☐ appearance.
- ☐ living arrangements.
- ☐ story.

'Off came his glasses, placed into their box
Next came the dentures and smelly grey socks.'
The poet's main purpose for this description is to

- ☐ list Gramps's health problems.
- ☐ emphasise the dullness of Gramps's routine.
- ☐ contrast Gramps's glasses and dentures.
- ☐ create a picture of Gramps for the reader.

Which of these steps is **not** part of Gramps's 'bedtime process'?

- ☐ removing his false teeth
- ☐ taking off his glasses
- ☐ washing his socks
- ☐ pulling off his wig

Describing Gramps's stay as 'short-lived' (line 17) means that

- ☐ he did not stay with Thomas for very long.
- ☐ he was not intending to sleep overnight.
- ☐ he only had a brief time between visits.
- ☐ he quickly changed his mind about staying.

According to Granny, why did Gramps go to Thomas's house?

- ☐ He needed somewhere to stay.
- ☐ He had a disagreement with her.
- ☐ He wanted to spend time with Thomas.
- ☐ He was invited by Thomas to visit.

In the final stanza, Granny called Thomas McClay's mother to

- ☐ explain the reason for Gramps's visit.
- ☐ suggest that Gramps stop telling stories.
- ☐ ask Thomas to send Gramps home.
- ☐ show support for Gramps's actions.

From whose point of view is the poem written?

☐

Gramps

☐

Granny

☐

Thomas McClay

☐

Shelley Wylie

Spacious Shell for Sale

This is a unique opportunity for a young yellow-footed or striped-leg hermit crab to acquire a charming shell. It provides very suitable accommodation with a generous living area for you to draw your body inside, with room on the outer lip for both pincers.

Offering great protection against predators, this attractive winkle with only one previous owner would suit a growing hermit crab. It is clean and ready for occupation.

The architecture of this shell is magnificent, with a well-sculptured spiral. This striped periwinkle is nearly two centimetres long and pale yellow in colour. It is cone-shaped, with rounded whorls, and a distinctive pattern of brown and white bands, like zebra stripes.

Only recently vacated, it was much loved by its previous owner and remains in excellent condition.

You will be able to scuttle across the bottom of the seabed, taking this delightful home with you. We guarantee that it will not be too heavy in the water.

Your new shell inhabits a shallow tidal pool and has excellent water views. The area surrounding this shell home provides a pleasant environment to live in, close to food sources such as plankton and worms.

The shell's surface comes with the bonus of several species of sponges and a sea anemone attached. These guests will give protection and provide camouflage for the new owner. Or, if you prefer, you can bring your own decorative disguises!

Please take time to examine this stately residence, which would provide a wonderful hermitage for any hermit crab. But hurry to make your inspection of this pre-loved seaside dwelling before another young equal-handed crab snaps it up!



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SEASHORES REAL ESTATE

For all your growing
shell home requirements

Text: "Spacious Shell for Sale" text by Margaret Etherton published in The School Magazine April 2014. Images: © Janison Solutions Pty Limited



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Spacious Shell for Sale

Which word from the first paragraph is used as a synonym for '*Spacious*'?

☐

'unique'

☐

'charming'

☐

'suitable'

☐

'generous'

According to Seashores Real Estate, the shell for sale is most suitable for a

☐

shy crab.

☐

young crab.

☐

wealthy crab.

☐

family of crabs.

Which feature is **not** described as an advantage of the shell?

- ☐ It is newly built.
- ☐ It is well designed.
- ☐ It is lightweight.
- ☐ It is well located.

'The shell's surface comes with the bonus of several species of sponges and a sea anemone attached.' (paragraph 7)

According to the text, why is this a 'bonus'?

- ☐ The crab will have other sea creatures for company.
- ☐ The shell will be more attractive with decorations included.
- ☐ There will be plenty of food for the crab to eat.
- ☐ There will be greater security for the new owner of the shell.

Which phrase from the text refers to the shell home for sale?

☐

'a growing hermit crab'

☐

'a shallow tidal pool'

☐

'a pleasant environment'

☐

'a wonderful hermitage'

In the final paragraph, there are two meanings of the phrase 'snaps it up'. The first refers to the snap of a crab's pincers.

What is the second meaning?

☐

to grab something quickly

☐

to break an agreement

☐

to lift something into the air

☐

to share a prize fairly

Apart from writing to persuade, the main purpose of the text is to

- ☐ provide readers with useful instructions.
- ☐ entertain readers with a humorous idea.
- ☐ interest readers using scientific explanations.
- ☐ inform readers of an exciting adventure.

Forest fire

New Zealand is well-known for its interesting and unique natural features: geysers, boiling mud, hot water beaches and thermal pools to name a few. However, in the South Island, close to the small rural town of Murchison, something very mysterious indeed is happening in an area of a rainforest.

Ordinarily, flames in a forest would be a cause for alarm but the flames in the Murchison rainforest are more a cause for curiosity. First reports of the flames in the forest date back to the 1920s. Local histories about the discovery of the flames vary, but typically involve two hunters (or farmers), one of whom bravely (or perhaps foolishly) lit a match (or accidentally threw away a match). Either way, the flames have been burning ever since, except when the occasional heavy downpour of rain or strong wind extinguishes them. However, the flames are easily re-lit since the gas continues to seep from the ground. Tour guides monitor the flames and can easily, but carefully, reignite them should they go out for any reason.

Science provides an answer to the origin of the flames: they are fuelled by natural methane and other gases which emerge from cracks in rocks on the forest floor. The flames rise up eerily close to trees, and are surrounded by moss and ferns. Visitors to the flames report the bizarre sight of small flames rising out of the ground. There is enough heat in the flames to cook food and some people take advantage of the free energy to cook a snack.

Although the New Zealand forest flames are unusual, there are instances of similar occurrences in other parts of the world. In the Cirali Mountains of Turkey, methane and other gases emerge constantly through the rocks to create flames of varying heights. Historically, sailors used the flames for navigation—a natural lighthouse. Ancient writers believed that these flames were the source of the myth of the Chimera—a frightening creature that breathed fire when threatened.

Even though the story of the New Zealand flames is modest compared with that of the natural flames of the Cirali Mountains, it is equally fascinating.



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Forest flames, New Zealand

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At the end of the first paragraph, the writer tries to create a sense of

- ☐ acceptance.
- ☐ optimism.
- ☐ sympathy.
- ☐ intrigue.

Which word could **not** replace 'Ordinarily' in the second paragraph?

- ☐ Usually
- ☐ Generally
- ☐ Normally
- ☐ Actually

'Ordinarily, flames in a forest would be a cause for alarm but the flames in the Murchison rainforest are more a cause for curiosity.' (paragraph 2)
Why has the writer used the words 'alarm' and 'curiosity' in this sentence?

- ☐ to avoid repetition
- ☐ to create contrast
- ☐ to help the rhythm
- ☐ to build imagery

In the second paragraph, the words in the brackets are used to

- ☐ identify errors.
- ☐ define meanings.
- ☐ emphasise the points.
- ☐ provide alternative theories.

In the third paragraph, the writer most likely uses the phrase 'eerily close' to suggest that the location of the flames

- ☐ is incredible and unnatural.
- ☐ is imposing and unmanageable.
- ☐ is dangerous and puzzling.
- ☐ is damaging and problematic.

The most likely reason that tour guides reignite the flames is to ensure that

- ☐ there is no dangerous build-up of gases.
- ☐ visitors can observe the flames.
- ☐ scientists can research the flames.
- ☐ the forest is not harmed by the gases.

Which of these words from the text is closest in meaning to 'bizarre'? (paragraph 3)

☐

'occasional'

☐

'natural'

☐

'unusual'

☐

'modest'

Which option describes the writer's viewpoint in the last paragraph?

☐

She knows that the Turkish flames have a longer history but believes that the New Zealand ones are more captivating.

☐

She argues that both flames should have the same status because of their similar origins.

☐

She admits that the Turkish flames are more well-known but thinks that both flames are interesting.

☐

She thinks that the New Zealand flames deserve better recognition than the more famous Turkish flames.

Results

Question number	Correct answer	Mark	Category	Descriptor
1	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Infer the writer's objective in a diary entry
2	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Understand the use of idiomatic language in a diary entry
3	C	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Identify the meaning of a word in a diary entry: smug
4	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret the reason for an event in a diary entry
5	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the reason for a marker on a map in a diary entry
6	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the writer's self-assessment of an event in a diary entry
7	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Infer the writer's viewpoint about a character's actions in a diary entry
8	B	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify the punctuation in an interview transcript that shows a pause
9	A	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Identify the illustration that explains the meaning of a word: protruding
10	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Recognise the purpose of a question in an interview
11	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify factual information in an interview
12	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the interviewee's words that gives evidence for an inference
13	B	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify the pronoun reference in an interview
14	D	☐ ☐	Syntax	Explain the function of brackets in an interview transcript
15	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Analyse an interview to describe its characteristics
16	D	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Interpret the meaning of a word in a factual description: delicacy
17	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the word that supports an inference in a factual description
18	A	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Identify the feature in a table in a factual description that is used to distinguish information
19	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify a correct statement from information in a table in a factual description
20	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret the reason for an authorial comment in a factual description
21	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Analyse a factual description to identify a correct statement
22	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret the tone of the final sentence in a factual description
23	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Analyse a factual description to infer an assumption about the readers
24	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify what a description refers to in a poem
25	D	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Understand the purpose of a description in a poem
26	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify a step that doesn't belong in a sequence of events in a poem
27	A	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Interpret the meaning of a word in a poem: short-lived
28	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the reason for a character's action in a poem
29	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the purpose of a character's action in a poem
30	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Analyse a poem to identify its narrator

Results

Question number	Correct answer	Mark	Category	Descriptor
31	D	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Identify a synonym in context in an advertisement: spacious
32	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the audience of an advertisement
33	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the main arguments in an advertisement
34	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the reason for a claim made in an advertisement
35	D	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify a noun group used to maintain cohesion in an advertisement
36	A	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Interpret a play on words in an advertisement
37	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Analyse an advertisement to identify its main purposes
38	D	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Identify the mood at the beginning of a text
39	D	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify synonyms for a connective in a factual text
40	B	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Analyse vocabulary choice in a factual text
41	D	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Identify the particular use of brackets by the writer of a factual text
42	A	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Interpret the use of a descriptive phrase in a factual text
43	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Infer a likely reason for an action described in a factual text
44	C	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Identify a synonym in a factual text: bizarre
45	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the writer's point of view in a factual text

You have completed this practice test.

Your mark is

0 / 45

0%

Click here to reset the test and try again.



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- Page 32 Photo of Murchison forest flames in New Zealand photographed by Naomi Arnold.

